

No know-how for Linux

I am a not too much of an expert on computers, but I believe that Linux has not moved into the home PC, because of its complex nature and difficult interface.

There are applications for Linux that can be downloaded and installed on the fly, yet for most desktop users, Linux is still an enigma.

My personal experience has been somewhat frustrating—I bought a PC from a reputed MNC with Mandrake Linux 7.0 preinstalled. After a hard drive format, I tried installing Linux with the system engineer, but gave up after we couldn't figure out what to do following the Welcome screen after booting off the Linux CD. I have since switched over to Windows XP.

This is what I'd like to say—Linux hasn't become popular because there aren't enough professionals who can teach newbies such as me. I'd like to see PC manufacturers train their engineers in Linux, especially since they distribute the OS with their PCs.

It's also quite difficult to get more applications, since the only source of Linux distros and applications are magazine CDs. In a country such as India, with most of us connecting to the Internet via dial-up, downloading large files is impossible.

S Praveen Bhargava

Dear Praveen,

You have touched upon several pertinent points. It is surprising the company's service engineer could not aid you with the install. Yes, companies must make the effort to train their engineers on Linux, and also offer users the necessary skills to get started on the Linux desktop. It's also sad to note that for a quality product such as Linux, software support outside of the distribution is severely limited to a few applications, and updates and patches on magazine CDs.

Swiss army knife in action

Last month, *Digit* asked readers to come up with an innovative way in which the Victorinox Swiss Army Knife USB stick could be used. Here is one:

Suppose you are an extreme sports enthusiast. You take one step too many in the wrong direction, and before you know it, you are lost. Your gear is carried away by the floodwaters, and food is fast running out. It is a race against time, but slowly, Nature gets its death grip on you. The last you remember is you passing out.

A team of rescuers finds you. There is nothing to identify you except the USB Victorinox. The rescue team plugs it into their laptop or PDA, and finds personal data, including the your blood group, contact details, etc.

They radio for help, and soon the rescue machinery is put into motion. You are now safe.

Prof Unnikrishnan Panickar



Dear Prof Panickar

We loved your idea. We hope adventure enthusiasts actually use it, and god forbid some calamity strikes, they can save themselves thanks to the information on the USB stick.

digit

The Winner of the 'Post your best Planet Digit Experience' contest is...

Deep

Joined:

23 Jan 2004

Posts: 341

Location:

Mumbai, India

Posted: Mon Mar 15, 2004 3:06 pm **Post Subject:** Gmail

Yes, I haven't made any mistake here... it's 1 GB and that too FREE. I think this shall answer the questions asked before regarding Bigger free mail storage

Quote:

"Google plans to use its search technology and a large amount of data storage to launch a free e-mail service that lets customers keep about 1GB of messages, the Internet search giant announced Wednesday."

Website : www.GMail.com

This is super HOT... amazing.

Dexter

Joined:

24 Dec 2003

Posts: 317

Location:

Mumbai, India

Posted: Wed Mar 17, 2004 10:03 am **Post Subject:**

That's an April Fools Day prank. I don't think Google is offering 1 GB... In fact, hours after Google's press release, came the news that Microsoft was gonna give 1 TB of free space. Why? Because it's 1,000 times more than Google!

Dexter

Joined:

24 Dec 2003

Posts: 317

Location:

Mumbai, India

Posted: Wed Mar 17, 2004 10:03 am **Post Subject:**

OK, so there's a correction: Gmail is not an April Fools Day prank. Actually I learnt about it right after I posted it here, but it seems that actual prank that Google pulled off was that it was offering a job on the moon...

Goof Ups

- The price for the Canon i225 was mentioned as Rs 3,995 in the Scoreboard on page 53. The correct price is Rs 4,500, after taxes.
- The picture of the graphics card in the A-list on page 76 should have been the Ennyah GeForce FX 5700, instead of the Compro card shown.
- The Ennyah GeForce FX 5700 was also the cause of a Expensive-Cheap confusion. As a value performer in the A-list, the card is expensive. But compared for pure performance with other cards in that range, it's justified.

Notice any goof-ups?

Write to goof@jasubhai.com

E-mail: readersletters@jasubhai.com

Send your letters marked 'Readers Letters' to the Digit office:

D-222/2, Om Sagar Building, MIDC, TTC Industrial Estate, Nerul, Navi Mumbai 400 706

Phone: 022-27629191/9200 Fax: 022-27629224